READING PASSAGE 2

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 14-26**, which are based on Reading Passage 2 on the following pages.*

Questions 14–20

*Reading Passage 2 has seven paragraphs, **A–G**.*

Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.

*Write the correct number, **i–xi**, in boxes 14–20 on your answer sheet.*

List of Headings

i	Training coin makers
ii	A form of regional promotion
iii	More gold than silver in Greece
iv	Calculating what a coin was worth
v	A simpler, more efficient way of trading
vi	Putting a face to famous historical names
vii	An uncertain future
viii	Careless workmanship caused breakages
ix	Unchanging coins signalled trustworthiness
x	Reading the writing on coins
xi	Significant records of past societies

14 Paragraph **A**

15 Paragraph **B**

16 Paragraph **C**

17 Paragraph **D**

18 Paragraph **E**

19 Paragraph **F**

20 Paragraph **G**

Coins – the first form of money

A Few people pay much attention to coins; we take them for granted. Since the advent of paper currency and the abandonment of a monetary system based on intrinsic or actual value, they have been demoted to the status of change: what is left when you have paid for something with ‘paper’ money. There is even a belief that they will one day be obsolete, as will paper or plastic notes, and money will at last have achieved the pure status of a mathematical formulation, a system of electronic credits and debits.

B In the modern media environment, the sheer number of visual images is overwhelming, but it makes one stop to think that coins are among the most durable of our artefacts, and future archaeologists will scrutinise coins in order to learn about their distant ancestors. This is exactly the way ancient coins have informed us for over four millennia. There are thousands of different coins, each designed to carry meaning as well as value, tiny but rich sources of documentary evidence about events and cultural attitudes, frequently produced with exquisite craftsmanship.

C Coins in Europe date from 2,500 to 2,700 years ago, and seem to have originated in the ancient kingdom of Lydia, in what is now Turkey. Before coins, trade was based on barter: the direct trade of commodities. Barter required the physical presence of both commodities that were being traded. Metal coins were far more portable, and not subject to the same spoilage on long sea journeys as a commodity like grain might be if it became wet. However, they could also be accumulated, and these hoards could be stolen. Coins were therefore a temptation to criminals. The Greeks, however, were the first to realise the full potential of the new invention. They were a trading people of seafarers. Their civilisation, which was composed of dozens of city-states, was highly decentralised. Despite the potential for theft, the Greeks realised that they could benefit enormously from a system that used coins, because it meant that they no longer had to carry goods with them to barter.

D The value of coins was generally based on the intrinsic value of the metal they were made of. At first this was mostly silver, and this meant that the discovery of silver mines on Greek territory actually increased the quantity of money they could produce. Had the Greek mining been on a larger scale, it could have caused problems similar to those faced by the Spanish centuries later, when so much gold from the New World was brought into their economy that it resulted in serious inflation. One advantage of intrinsic value was that coins could be weighed to determine the amount of metal they contained, so that the only thing an issuing state had to guarantee was the purity of the metal to prevent accusations of fraud and cheating, which could cause fighting and unrest. This was quite difficult to do, especially with coins made of gold, until Archimedes realised that different metals have different weight-volume ratios, and that by measuring the amount of displacement when coins were immersed in water, it was possible to establish whether gold was alloyed with silver.

E All ancient coins were made by hand using engraved metal moulds. Many hundreds of coins were made, and as a result the moulds often cracked and new ones had to be engraved. This explains the endless variety encountered in coins with the same designs because the moulds had to be remade repeatedly, by many different artisans. One of the distinctive features of coins, in fact, is that they are the work of anonymous craftsmen, and yet each coin is an intimate reflection of the character of its city of origin. It was the Greeks who realised that coins could have a double function, as a unit of value and as a symbol of the identity of the city that issued them. The Greek view of life was deeply motivated by a spirit of competition, and coins, which circulated around the trading world, were a way of advertising the qualities of each particular city-state.

F Interestingly, Greek coins from the city of Athens, which was the home of the greatest sculptors of the classical period, seem to have been completely disconnected from the high sculptural tradition. The beautiful features of the city's patron, Athena (with her owl on the reverse of the coin), seem to have been repeated virtually unaltered for many years. Perhaps this was because the Athenian currency had grown increasingly to be the international standard and, like the US dollar today, a uniform design implied integrity.

G One side of a coin was always occupied by the head of a divinity, so it was a relatively small step, at around 323 BC, for Greek coins to replace that head with the portrait of the reigning monarch, a tradition that has continued in monarchies to the present day. Republics may have either symbolic heads going back to the older tradition of divinities or the features of a distinguished past head of state. The Romans adopted the Greek practice of coin design and as a result, the features of many great Romans have survived and are known to modern generations, despite the fact that the art of portrait painting was completely lost for more than a millennium following the fall of the Roman Empire.

Questions 21 and 22

*Choose **TWO** letters, **A–E**.*

Write the correct letters in boxes 21 and 22 on your answer sheet.

Which **TWO** of these comments about ancient coins are made by the writer of the text?

A There is no record of the names of the coin makers.
B Coins were not popular as payment for traded objects.
C Coins with the same design often looked quite different.
D Greek coins were more beautiful in design than Roman coins.
E At times, too many coins were produced in Greece.

Questions 23–26

Complete the summary below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 23–26 on your answer sheet.

Greek traders and coins

The ancient Greek **23** …… was made up of many city-states which were spread over a large area. Many Greeks were seafarers who travelled the seas trading. Before coins, they had to do this through **24** …… . This meant that, whenever they set out, they had to carry a lot of goods, which could get damaged on the voyages. The Greeks liked coins; they were made of metal, and the weather and sea had little effect on them. The Greeks had a plentiful supply of **25** …… which they mined themselves, but were able to avoid the problem of **26** …… which the Spanish encountered much later, after they allowed too much gold from the New World to enter their economy.

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Questions 14–20 Heading 题答案

Heading 翻译表

编号	Heading	中文翻译
i	Training coin makers	培训铸币工匠
ii	A form of regional promotion	一种地区宣传方式
iii	More gold than silver in Greece	希腊的黄金比白银更多
iv	Calculating what a coin was worth	计算硬币的价值
v	A simpler, more efficient way of trading	一种更简单、更高效的交易方式
vi	Putting a face to famous historical names	让著名历史人物有了面孔
vii	An uncertain future	不确定的未来
viii	Careless workmanship caused breakages	粗心的工艺导致破损
ix	Unchanging coins signalled trustworthiness	不变的硬币设计象征可信度
x	Reading the writing on coins	阅读硬币上的文字
xi	Significant records of past societies	过去社会的重要记录

题号	段落	答案	定位句	定位句翻译	详细解释
14	Paragraph A	vii	“There is even a belief that they will one day be obsolete… money will at last have achieved the pure status of a mathematical formulation, a system of electronic credits and debits.”	甚至有人相信，硬币有一天会被淘汰，纸币或塑料钞票也会如此；金钱最终会成为一种纯粹的数学形式，即电子贷记和借记系统。	A段先说人们现在不太重视硬币，认为它们只是“零钱”。最后重点转向硬币未来可能被电子货币取代。因此本段核心是硬币未来的不确定性，对应 **vii An uncertain future**。
15	Paragraph B	xi	“ancient coins have informed us for over four millennia… tiny but rich sources of documentary evidence about events and cultural attitudes”	古代硬币在四千多年里一直为我们提供信息；它们虽小，却是关于事件和文化态度的丰富文献证据。	B段强调硬币非常耐久，未来考古学家会通过硬币了解过去；古代硬币也已经帮助我们了解了几千年的历史。核心是硬币作为历史记录的重要价值，对应 **xi Significant records of past societies**。
16	Paragraph C	v	“Metal coins were far more portable…” / “they no longer had to carry goods with them to barter.”	金属硬币便携得多。/ 他们不再需要随身携带货物来进行物物交换。	C段对比了 barter（物物交换）和 coins（硬币交易）。物物交换需要双方实物同时存在，而且货物可能腐坏；硬币更便携、更适合贸易。因此本段核心是硬币让交易更简单、更高效，对应 **v A simpler, more efficient way of trading**。
17	Paragraph D	iv	“The value of coins was generally based on the intrinsic value of the metal they were made of.” / “coins could be weighed to determine the amount of metal they contained”	硬币的价值通常取决于其所含金属本身的内在价值。/ 硬币可以通过称重来确定其中所含金属的数量。	D段集中讨论硬币价值如何确定：根据金属本身价值、重量、纯度，还提到阿基米德通过排水量判断金币是否掺银。因此核心是“如何计算一枚硬币值多少钱”，对应 **iv Calculating what a coin was worth**。
18	Paragraph E	ii	“coins… were a way of advertising the qualities of each particular city-state.”	硬币是一种宣传每个特定城邦品质的方式。	E段前半部分讲手工铸币和模具变化，但后半段才是主旨：希腊人意识到硬币不仅是价值单位，也是城市身份的象征，并能在贸易世界中宣传各城邦。因此答案是 **ii A form of regional promotion**。注意不是 viii，因为模具破裂只是背景信息，不是主旨。
19	Paragraph F	ix	“The beautiful features… seem to have been repeated virtually unaltered for many years.” / “a uniform design implied integrity.”	这些美丽的形象似乎多年几乎没有变化地被反复使用。/ 统一的设计意味着诚信可靠。	F段讲雅典硬币长期保持相同图案，因为雅典货币逐渐成为国际标准，固定设计能传递可靠性和诚信。因此对应 **ix Unchanging coins signalled trustworthiness**。
20	Paragraph G	vi	“the features of many great Romans have survived and are known to modern generations”	许多伟大罗马人的容貌得以保存，并为现代人所知。	G段讲硬币上的头像从神祇变为君主肖像，后来罗马人也采用这种做法，使许多历史人物的面貌流传下来。因此本段核心是硬币让历史人物“有脸可识”，对应 **vi Putting a face to famous historical names**。

Questions 21–22 多选题答案

题干翻译：
作者在文章中提到了以下哪两条关于古代硬币的评论？
选择两个字母 A–E。

题号	答案	选项翻译	定位句	定位句翻译	详细解释
21/22	A	没有记录留下铸币工匠的名字。	“One of the distinctive features of coins, in fact, is that they are the work of anonymous craftsmen…”	事实上，硬币的一个显著特征是，它们是无名工匠的作品。	anonymous craftsmen = 无名工匠，说明这些制作者的名字没有被记录下来。因此 A 正确。
21/22	C	相同设计的硬币看起来常常很不一样。	“This explains the endless variety encountered in coins with the same designs because the moulds had to be remade repeatedly, by many different artisans.”	这解释了为什么同样设计的硬币会呈现出无穷的变化，因为模具必须由许多不同工匠反复重新制作。	endless variety + same designs 对应选项 C 中的 “same design often looked quite different”。因此 C 正确。

错误选项排除

选项	为什么错
B Coins were not popular as payment for traded objects.	错。C段说希腊人发现硬币有巨大好处，因为不必再携带货物去交换，说明硬币作为支付方式是受欢迎、有用的。
D Greek coins were more beautiful in design than Roman coins.	错。文章没有比较希腊硬币和罗马硬币谁更美。
E At times, too many coins were produced in Greece.	错。D段只是说“如果希腊采矿规模更大，可能会像后来西班牙那样造成通货膨胀”，这是虚拟假设，不是说希腊实际曾经生产过太多硬币。

Questions 23–26 Summary 填空题答案

题干翻译：
完成下面的总结。
每个答案只能从文章中选择 **一个单词**。

Summary 标题：Greek traders and coins

希腊商人与硬币

题号	答案	题目句子	题目句子翻译	定位句	定位句翻译	详细解释
23	civilisation	“The ancient Greek 23 _____ was made up of many city-states which were spread over a large area.”	古希腊的____由许多分布在广大区域内的城邦组成。	“Their civilisation, which was composed of dozens of city-states, was highly decentralised.”	他们的文明由几十个城邦组成，高度分散。	题目中的 “was made up of many city-states” 对应原文 “was composed of dozens of city-states”。空格前是 “The ancient Greek”，所以填名词 **civilisation**。
24	barter	“Before coins, they had to do this through 24 _____.”	在硬币出现之前，他们不得不通过____进行贸易。	“Before coins, trade was based on barter: the direct trade of commodities.”	在硬币出现之前，贸易以物物交换为基础，即商品之间的直接交换。	“Before coins” 原词复现，trade was based on barter 对应题目 “do this through barter”。答案是 **barter**。
25	silver	“The Greeks had a plentiful supply of 25 _____ which they mined themselves…”	希腊人有充足的____供应，并且他们自己开采。	“At first this was mostly silver, and this meant that the discovery of silver mines on Greek territory actually increased the quantity of money they could produce.”	起初这主要是白银，这意味着希腊领土上银矿的发现实际上增加了他们能够生产的钱币数量。	题目中的 “which they mined themselves” 对应原文 “silver mines on Greek territory”。希腊人开采的是 **silver**。
26	inflation	“…but were able to avoid the problem of 26 _____ which the Spanish encountered much later…”	但他们能够避免后来西班牙人遇到的____问题。	“…when so much gold from the New World was brought into their economy that it resulted in serious inflation.”	当来自新大陆的大量黄金进入他们的经济体系时，导致了严重的通货膨胀。	题目中的 “the Spanish encountered much later” 对应原文 “the Spanish centuries later”。西班牙遇到的问题是 serious inflation，因此答案是 **inflation**。